

Gayatri Niraj Sonawane

Senior Test Automation Lead | API & Data Validation Expert

Strategic **Senior Test Automation Lead** with 12+ years of experience delivering high-quality backend and data-driven solutions in FinTech and Healthcare. Expert in **API automation, ETL validation, and service virtualization**. Strong advocate of **Shift-Left testing** and CI/CD integration, recently expanding into **AI-assisted QA** to accelerate delivery cycles.

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Professional Experience

HCL Technologies Germany - Senior QA Lead

Aug 2021 - Present

- **Architected QA strategy** for Credit Risk Automation, validating complex risk engines and probability models.
- **Developed REST Assured suites** for backend services and credit integrations including Experian and Schufa.
- **Implemented WireMock** service virtualization to eliminate bottlenecks and enhance CI/CD stability.
- **Led Shift-Left initiatives**, identifying requirement gaps early through stakeholder engagement

Saama Technologies - QA Consultant

Feb 2015 - Feb 2021

- **Engineered ETL/DWH automation** scripts using SQL to validate large-scale data migrations and source-to-target mappings.
- **Led functional and SIT phases** for high-impact Life Science and Healthcare data projects.
- **Developed Tableau dashboards** to visualize data quality metrics for executive stakeholders.

Function Space Labs - Software Test Engineer

Jul 2014 - Dec 2014

- Delivered cross-platform testing (iOS, Android, Web) for E-Learning applications, focusing on usability and performance.
- Executed **compatibility and interruption testing** across diverse mobile devices.

Sycamore Software Solutions -Junior QA Engineer

Dec 2012 - Jun 2014

- Managed Localization (L10N) and backend data verification using SQL for high-traffic media portals.

Highlights

Multi-Role Contributor: Balanced Scrum Master, BA, and QA roles to drive team agility. **E2E Business Vision:** Expert at decomposing complex flows to analyze systemic impacts across cross-functional architectures. **Strategic Lead:** Bridges business requirements and technical execution through Shift-Left and impact analysis.

Technical Skills

Test Automation: Rest Assured, Selenium WebDriver, Playwright, Java, Cucumber/BDD, WireMock (Service Virtualization), JUnit/TestNG, Postman

AI-Driven Testing: Playwright MCP, Atlassian MCP, Prompt Engineering for QA

Data & Backend:SQL (Advanced), AWS Redshift, Apache Hive, ETL Testing, API Testing, Microservices Validation

Tools & Infrastructure :JIRA, Tableau, Git, CI/CD Pipelines, Unix/Shell

Education

MSc. Computer Science: Pune University India , 2012

BSc. Computer Science : Pune University India , 2010

Certifications

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) - 2025

Domain Expertise

FinTech & Banking (Credit Risk), Life Sciences & Healthcare, E-Learning , Media & Entertainment